

Problem 4: Epun

(25 marks)

Here are some sentences in Epun⁸ and their English translations:⁹

Midebiniz sminus fa vakvepiz.
Chavetius f imnikiniz gub midep.
Tak huspat asa smin?
Asa hahielogus chegodiniz.
Guza hakakolgu gub zenadin.
Chupanibu fa pelikin.
Osozeu uza imnipiz.
Tak hagupat gub imnidin kakol?
Afa bozudin cherehelgu gub vletop.
Tak chupat f imnikin osoze?
Nisa osozenis fa chegodopiz.
Af imnipiz bozudiniz havetigus.
Zaddiliniz hapanibus.
Makohin binapu.

Some kings kiss the walruses_M.
The cats_M won't love this queen.
What have they_M kissed?
Some dogs_F haven't looked at them.
This girl hasn't seen her.
The turtle_M won't come.
He doesn't catch some cats_F.
What has this cat_F seen?
The teacher_F will write this letter.
What will the cat_M catch?
We catch the dogs_M.
Some teachers_F have loved the cats_F.
Some men have come.
The boy returns.

Assignment 1: (3 marks)

Translate into English:

- (a) Tak hugupat panib?
- (b) Uza havetigu guza.
- (c) Pelikop nisa hakakolnis.

Assignment 2: (8 marks)

Translate into Epun:

- (a) The walrus_F will kiss us.
- (b) This man hasn't written a letter.
- (c) Some turtles_F don't look at a woman.
- (d) The boys have loved the queens.

Assignment 3: (6 marks)

Translate into Epun in all possible ways:

- (a) What do they love?

⁸Epun is an invented language, deliberately devised to contain constructions which violated universal grammatical principles.

⁹ch = ch in chop. The subscripts M and F refer to masculine and feminine, respectively.

(b) What will return?

Assignment 4: (8 marks)

Explain your solution.

– Vlad A. Neacșu (inspired by a problem created by Adina Dragomirescu)
